Testing Ruko: a guide for reviewers and evaluators

Ruko is an Android app that notices the **moment** a scam happens on the phone and pauses the person: a stranger on a call while a bank app opens, a scam message, a fake link, an app file. It warns on the screen, reads the warning aloud, and, only if the person chose it, alerts a family member. It never blocks anything, never records calls, and never sends messages or contacts off the phone.

This guide is for **Ruko version 11 (`1.2`)**, the full app. Everything below was checked against that version. Each sample message was run through the app's own checker before it was put here.

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1. What you need

Test phone	Android **10 or newer**. Ruko doesn't run on iPhone. On Android 8–9 it can't see who is calling, so the call tests won't work there.
A second phone	For call and message tests. Its number must **not be saved** in the test phone's contacts, because Ruko treats saved contacts as people you know.
Reviewer code	Ask the Ruko team. It unlocks the full app on the website.
Optional: a UPI or bank app on the test phone (PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, any bank app)	For the call tests. You don't have to pay; just open it.

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2. Install and set up (about 5 minutes)

1. On the test phone, open **getruko.vercel.app/install**.
2. Choose **Ruko (full)**, enter the **reviewer code**, and follow the steps on the page. The full app isn't on the Play Store yet, so Android asks you to allow the install; the page shows how.
3. Open Ruko and follow setup. It asks for these, each with a one-line reason:
   - **Let Ruko see who is calling** (make Ruko the "caller ID & spam" app)
   - **Let Ruko know when you're on a call**
   - **Let Ruko check if a caller is saved** (contacts)
   - **Let Ruko notice your bank app** (usage access)
   - **Let Ruko show the warning** (display over other apps)
   - **Let Ruko send you notifications**
   - **Also check your messages** (notification access)
4. Setup also asks who Ruko should call in a warning, and how:
   - **Just me:** only warns you. Pick this if you test alone.
   - **Ask me first:** the warning shows a big button to call them.
   - **Tell them automatically:** their phone rings. This needs Ruko on their phone too, paired with a code.
5. **Home must say "Protection is on".** If it says "Protection is off", tap **Fix it**.

6. For the link tests: **Settings → Links → "Check links before they open"** (Ruko becomes the default browser; it checks each link, then hands it to Chrome).
7. **Keep "Silent mode" off:** Settings → For testing. Silent mode logs warnings without showing them.
8. **Keep Ruko running.** Battery savers on Xiaomi/Redmi, Oppo, Vivo, Realme, OnePlus and Samsung phones stop apps in the background, and a stopped Ruko can't warn. Follow the steps for your phone at **getruko.vercel.app/keep-running** before you start testing. If Home ever says "Protection is off", tap **Fix it**.

Truecaller users: Android allows only one caller ID app. While Ruko holds that role, Truecaller doesn't show spam names on calls. You can switch back after testing.

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3. The rules, in plain words

Ruko only acts when a rule matches. A "stranger" is any number **not saved** in contacts.

Rule	When it fires	What you see	Family member
R1 Bank or UPI app on a call	A stranger has been on the call **2+ minutes** and a bank or UPI app opens	Red **"Pause. This call looks like a scam."**, read aloud; "Continue" unlocks after 30 seconds	Follows your choice (Just me / Ask me first / Tell them automatically)
R1 early	Same, but the call is **under 2 minutes**	Calm **"Is this someone you know?"** "No, I don't know them" turns it into the red warning	Only after "No"
R1 after the call	A bank or UPI app opens within **10 minutes after** a 2+ minute stranger call	Calm question: **"Did the caller from 4:12 pm ask you to open PhonePe?"** "Yes, they asked me" gives the red warning; "No, I opened it myself" ends it	Only after "Yes"
R2 Screen sharing	A stranger is on the call (any length) and a screen-sharing app opens (AnyDesk, TeamViewer and 26 others)	Red **"Stop. This is a scam."**	Follows your choice
R3 A code (OTP) on a call	A bank code or bank text arrives **during** a stranger's call	Red warning: "Don't share this code or OTP with anyone. Hang up."	Follows your choice
R3 after the call	An OTP within 10 minutes after a 2+ minute stranger call	Calm question: **"Did the caller from 4:12 pm ask you for this code?"**	Only after "Yes"
Delivery codes	An Amazon, Flipkart or courier delivery code during the call	A calm notification only	Never
R4 Very long call	A stranger keeps you on a call 45+ minutes (30 for video)	Off by default; a switch in Settings sends a calm note to your family member	Only if switched on
R6 Scam message	A scam message in SMS, WhatsApp, Telegram, Instagram, Messenger, Truecaller or SMS Organizer	**"Pause. This message looks like a scam."** (red), or calm teal **"You're safe. Nothing has happened."** for known tricks that aren't urgent	Only for a fake link or app file **while a stranger is on the call**

Rule	When it fires	What you see	Family member
R7 Opened a scam site anyway	You tapped "Open anyway" on a red link	Nothing more on your screen	Only in "Tell them automatically"
R8 Installing after a warning	The app installer opens within 30 minutes of an app-file warning	Red warning	Follows your choice
Link check	You tap a link anywhere (with "Check links before they open" on)	Red **"Pause. This link looks like a scam."** or amber **"Be careful with this link"**; ordinary sites open straight away	Through R7 only

Things Ruko deliberately does not judge:

- **What saved contacts write.** Their fake links and app files still warn.
- **Wording from WhatsApp businesses and registered SMS senders** (`VM-HDFCBK`). Their fake links still warn.

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4. Test A: scam messages, no second phone needed

On the test phone: **Home** → **Check a message**. Paste one message at a time and tap **Check**. You can also choose a screenshot, or long-press a message in WhatsApp → Share → Ruko.

Expected for every scam below: "This looks like a scam.", with the reason and **"The scam it matches"** (the card named in the table).

#	Paste this	Ruko should find
S1	`Dear SBI customer, your YONO account will be blocked today. Update your PAN and KYC immediately: https://sbi-kyc-update.top/login`	Fake bank "KYC expired" message (fake SBI site)
S2	`Your vehicle KA01AB1234 has a pending e-challan of Rs 500. Pay now to avoid court action: https://echallan-parivahan.in/pay`	Fake traffic e-challan (a reported scam site)
S3	`SBI KYC AADHAR UPDATE.apk`	App file (APK)
S4	`Dear consumer, your electricity connection will be disconnected tonight at 9:30 PM because your previous month bill is not updated. Please contact our electricity officer immediately 9876543210`	Fake "your electricity will be cut tonight"
S5	`NOTICE Maharashtra Natural Gas Limited. Dear pipe line MNGL Gas user Your connection will be disconnected tonight 09:30 PM Because your previous month Bill is Not updated. Please immediately call our bill update Officer Mr RAHUL JOSHI 9101830424`	Fake gas company: "connection will be cut tonight"
S6	`India Post: Your parcel could not be delivered due to incomplete address. Update your address within 24 hours: https://indiapost-redelivery.top`	Fake India Post "parcel stuck"
S7	`Hi, sorry, I sent a 6 digit code to your number by mistake. Can you please send it to me? It's urgent.`	"I sent you a code by mistake": WhatsApp takeover

#	Paste this	Ruko should find
S8	`ALERT: Your phone is infected with 3 viruses! Tap here to clean now and protect your bank apps`	Fake "your phone has a virus" pop-up
S9	`Diwali rush! Confirmed train tickets available for all routes. Pay advance to railseva.booking@ybl and get PNR in 10 min`	Fake booking
S10	`Part time job offer! Earn Rs 3000 daily by liking YouTube videos. Work from home, no investment. Contact HR on Telegram now`	Fake part-time job / online tasks
S11	`Income Tax Department: You are eligible for a refund of Rs 15,490. Submit your bank account details to receive it: https://incometax-refund-gov.in`	Fake income-tax refund
S12	`Rs 5,000 has been debited from your A/c XX1234 on 28-10-26. If not done by you, reply NO to block the transaction.`	Fake "money debited" alert that asks you to reply NO
S13	`Diwali bumper offer, extra 10% off today only: https://bit.ly/4hduPgG`	A short link that hides where it goes
S14	`Fill your KYC form here: https://kyc-form-2026.trycloudflare.com`	A temporary "tunnel" link
S15	`Pay your traffic fine here: https://echallan.party`	Fake traffic e-challan (a reported scam site)
S16	`This is CBI. Your Aadhaar is linked to a money laundering case. You are under digital arrest. Do not tell anyone. Transfer Rs 2,00,000 to the RBI verification account now or you will be arrested.`	Fake police / CBI "digital arrest"

Genuine messages: all should show **"No known scam pattern"** when pasted. They are what real messages look like **as text**. When a message actually arrives, Ruko also looks at who sent it: G1 and G3 are real only from a bank's or company's sender code (`VM-SBIBNK`), not from a personal mobile number (see Test B).

#	Paste this
G1	`123456 is your OTP for login to YONO SBI. Do not share it with anyone. -SBI`
G2	`PNR:4512345678, Trn:12627, Dt:05-11-26, Frm SBC to NDLS, Cls:3A, Chart prepared. Confirmed: B2 34`
G3	`Your Amazon order will be delivered today. Share OTP 4821 with the delivery agent only at the time of delivery.`
G4	`Beta, I reached home safely. Call me when you are free.`
G5	`Police alert: never tap pop-ups saying there is a virus on your phone. Close the page and call 1930 if you lost money.`
G6	`Dear Consumer, your BESCOM bill of Rs 1,245 for Oct-2026 is due on 05-11-2026. Pay at bescom.co.in or the BESCOM app.`
G7	`Hi! The saree I told you about is on sale: https://www.nykaa.com/sale`
G8	`File your ITR before 31 July on the official site https://www.incometax.gov.in`

Check a message doesn't know who sent the text, so it judges it as if from an unknown number. A real brand's offer with a bit.ly link is flagged here, even though the same offer from the brand's WhatsApp business account isn't.

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5. Test B: scam messages from the second phone

Send S1–S16 from the second phone by **SMS or WhatsApp**. Lock the test phone or leave the chat: Ruko reads notifications, and WhatsApp shows none for a chat you're looking at.

Expected: a full-screen warning naming the sender, the app and the first line.

- **Red "Pause. This message looks like a scam."** for urgent tricks: bank KYC, e-challan, app files, India Post, WhatsApp code, virus, tax refund, digital arrest, links with no card.
- **Calm teal "You're safe. Nothing has happened."** for known tricks that aren't urgent: electricity, gas, booking, part-time job, "reply NO". These turn red if a stranger called in the last 10 minutes.
- On a locked phone, the warning waits and is the first thing you see when you unlock.

Good to know:

- **The same message isn't warned about twice within 2 hours** (WhatsApp shows messages again when you open the chat). To repeat a test, change a word.
- **G1 and G3 sent from a personal number get a warning:** "looks like a bank message but comes from an ordinary mobile number". That's intended. Real bank and delivery codes come from sender codes like `VM-SBIBNK`, never from a +91 mobile number.
- **On Android 15 and newer, code messages are hidden from Ruko.** Android shows apps like Ruko only "Sensitive notification content hidden" for a message that looks like a one-time code: no text, no sender. So G1 or G3 from a personal number is **not** flagged on those phones outside a call. **During a stranger's call** a hidden code still gives the red warning (rule R3), which is the moment a code gets stolen. This is an Android limit: Ruko never asks for permission to read SMS.
- **From a saved contact,** S4–S12 and S16 (wording) are quiet by design. The links in S1, S2, S6, S11, S15 and the app file in S3 still warn.

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6. Test C: calls (second phone needed)

Call the test phone from the second phone and **answer**. Use a timer.

#	Do this	Expected
C1	Talk for **more than 2 minutes**, then open PhonePe / GPay / a bank app **while still on the call**	Red "Pause. This call looks like a scam.", read aloud, "Continue" after 30 s; the family member per your choice
C2	New call: open the bank app in the **first 2 minutes**	Calm "Is this someone you know?" "Yes, I know them" saves the number; "No, I don't know them" shows the red warning
C3	During a call, open a screen-sharing app (e.g. install **AnyDesk** from the Play Store before the call, then open it)	Red "Stop. This is a scam."

#	Do this	Expected
C4	During a call, get a one-time code sent to the test phone (e.g. log in to any app that texts a code)	Red warning about the code. On Android 15+ the code text may be hidden; it still counts
C5	Talk **2+ minutes**, hang up, then within 10 minutes open the bank app	Calm question "Did the caller from [time] ask you to open [app]?" Try **"Yes, they asked me"** (red warning) and, on another call, **"No, I opened it myself"** (nothing more for that call)
C6	Same, but after hang-up get an OTP	"Did the caller from [time] ask you for this code?"
C7	Call **under 2 minutes**, hang up, open the bank app	Nothing
C8	Tap **"I know this caller"** on any call warning, then call again from the same phone	No more warnings for that number. Undo: Settings → Never warn about
C9	Call from a **saved** contact, open the bank app	Nothing

7. Test D: links (with "Check links before they open" on)

Send these from the second phone by WhatsApp or SMS, then **tap** them on the test phone:

Link	Expected
`https://sbi-kyc-update.top/login`	Red "Pause. This link looks like a scam." (uses SBI's name). "Open anyway" unlocks after 5 seconds
`https://www.nykaa.com/sale`	Opens normally
`https://bit.ly/4hduPgG`	Amber "Be careful with this link" (short link)
Same bit.ly, with **Settings → Links → "Check where short links lead"** on	Ruko asks bit.ly where it goes (without opening the page), finds Myntra's real site, and opens it
`https://kyc-form-2026.trycloudflare.com`	Amber (temporary tunnel site)
`https://my-shop-demo.vercel.app` **during a stranger's call**	Amber; the same link outside a call opens normally

Optional, off by default: **"Also check websites online"** (Google Web Risk) and **"Check how new a website is"** (sites under 30 days old get stricter). Each sends only the website's name.

8. Other things to look at

- **Home → Scams going around:** cards for 53 current scams, with what they say, what they ask for, the red flag and what to do from an official source. **Listen** reads them aloud.
- **Can you spot the scam?** A quiz of real and fake messages.
- **Settings → Language:** English, Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada (the five Indian languages are marked beta). Warnings are read aloud in the chosen language.

- **Settings → For testing → Setup check:** every permission, **Show a test warning**, and the **test log** (events only, never names, numbers or message text). **Share the test log** sends it as a CSV file.

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9. What Ruko doesn't do (so you don't count it as a bug)

- Scam calls on **Skype, Zoom, Meet or Instagram** aren't watched. Phone and WhatsApp calls are.
- **Calls you make** are treated as known, including a fake helpline found online.
- **A saved contact's words** are never judged; their fake links and app files are.
- **Money moved off this phone** (laptop, bank branch, cash) can't be seen.
- **A brand-new scam site with an ordinary name** may get no warning: the address gives nothing away. The reported-sites list and the optional age check help here.
- **A chat you have open** produces no notification, so Ruko can't read it.
- A message that arrives in the few seconds while Ruko restarts (update, reboot) isn't checked.
- Ruko never blocks anything: the person can always continue.

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10. Privacy, briefly

Ruko never listens to or records calls, never reads SMS directly, and never sends message text, contacts or numbers off the phone. If a family member is alerted, they get only which rule fired and when. Online link checks are **off by default** and send only a website's name (or, for "Check where short links lead", the short link to the service that made it). Details: **getruko.vercel.app/privacy**.

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11. Sending feedback

For anything unexpected:

1. Take a screenshot of the warning, or of the message that wasn't flagged.
2. Note the time.
3. Settings → For testing → **Share the test log**.
4. Send all three to the Ruko team.

The log holds only events (e.g. `MESSAGE_SEEN … risky=LINK`), which is enough to see which rule fired.